

Steve Desmarais, Network Engineer

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SUMMARY

Dynamic Network Engineer with over 14 years of experience specializing in cloud and network infrastructure. Proven expertise in leading complex network migrations to Microsoft Azure and managing extensive Palo Alto firewall deployments. Successfully designed and implemented robust routing topologies and redundancy solutions to enhance network reliability. Track record of supporting enterprise networks and optimizing performance through strategic upgrades. Prepared to leverage unique skills to enhance connectivity and security in a forward-thinking organization.

WORK EXPERIENCE

06/2020 – 09/2025	Senior Cloud Platform Network Engineer, Charles River Development / State Street	Arlington, United States
	• Spearheaded network migration and infrastructure build-out into Microsoft Azure cloud utilizing Hub-Spoke architecture, NSG, and ExpressRoute. • Engineered and managed over 36 Palo Alto firewalls via the Panorama platform. • Instituted Private Link/Private Endpoint Services for clients through ExpressRoute. • Oversaw Azure firewalls, Network Security Groups, and Route Tables to enhance security and connectivity. • Developed and configured new VNets to optimize cloud network performance. • Administered Checkpoint GAIA firewalls, executing upgrades and policy modifications.	
11/2015 – 02/2020	Network Operations Manager, Continuum Managed Services	Arlington, United States
	• Directed enterprise-wide Cisco and Meraki network operations, encompassing Layer 3 switching, wireless solutions, and VoIP. • Architected BGP, EIGRP, and OSPF routing topologies and integrated redundancy/HA solutions to ensure network reliability. • Led Level 2/3 support and engineering initiatives for WAN/LAN infrastructure improvements. • Executed Cisco ACS, IPsec VPNs, HSRP routing, and VOIP solutions to enhance network security and performance.	
12/2015 – 09/2016	Network Security Advisor (Remote, 3rd Shift), Dell SecureWorks	Arlington, United States
	• Configured and upheld rigorous security policies across Checkpoint, Fortinet, and Juniper firewalls. • Addressed security incidents and delivered remote firewall support to global clientele.	

07/2012 – 10/2015	Senior Network Engineer (Contract), Wyless	Arlington, United States
	- Established VPN/IPSec tunnels to AWS and Azure leveraging Cisco ASA and Checkpoint technology. - Deployed SolarWinds Orion and NetFlow for comprehensive visibility and performance monitoring. - Implemented BGP, VRF, and PBR solutions to facilitate global MPLS and VPN connectivity.	
06/2013 – 06/2015	Senior NOC Engineer, ColoSpace	Somerville, United States
	- Supported customer environments and executed internal network upgrades across multiple data centers. - Migrated backend infrastructure from Cisco to Juniper technologies to streamline operations. - Designed Aruba Wireless architecture and facilitated intra-office networking enhancements.	
10/2006 – 06/2012	Senior Network Engineer, REIT Management	Arlington, United States
	- Led significant network projects including data center build-outs, VoIP deployment, and Metro-E integration. - Deployed Nexus 5000/2000/1000V and Cisco Wireless Controllers to enhance network functionality. - Implemented two-factor authentication (2FA) via RSA SecureID, IPsec tunnels, Radius/TACACS+, and enterprise monitoring solutions.	

EDUCATION

1990 – 1992	Newbury College, Lowell, MA A.S., Accounting	Lowell
	Summa Cum Laude	

SKILLS

Cisco Routers

Nexus

APs

Panorama

Checkpoint

Fortinet

Big-IP

Aruba

BGP

EIGRP

NAT

PVSTP+

TACACS+

SSL VPN

Dial peers

MPLS

Microsoft Azure

NSGs

VPNs

AWS

EC2

vSphere

Virtual Firewalls

SolarWinds

NetFlow

What's Up Gold

MRTG

NetQoS

NMS

IP SLA

AD

DHCP

IIS

Linux

Ubuntu

UNIX

MS Office

Outlook

Samba

Exchange Server

cross-team coordination

ASA

Meraki

Palo Alto

Juniper EX/MX

Symantec

F5

3DNS

HSRP

OSPF

RIP

ACLs

RADIUS

IPSec VPN

VOIP

Call Manager

PBR

ExpressRoute

VNETs

Hub-Spoke

VPC

VMware

Cisco 1000V

Hybrid Cloud Migrations

Orion

EM7

RANCID

HP Network Node Manager

Transcend

SNMP

Windows Server

DNS

RAS

SMS

Red Hat

Solaris

Novell NetWare

Project

Apache

Norton Ghost

Antivirus platforms

international team management

CERTIFICATES

Cisco Certified Network Professional (CCNP)

MCSE – Microsoft Certified Systems Engineer

F5 Big-IP & 3DNS

Solaris Systems Training

Sun Microsystems